

Restore

IICRC Standards Reference

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About IICRC Standards

The Institute of Inspection, Cleaning and Restoration Certification (IICRC) sets the standards for the restoration industry.

All Restore technicians must be familiar with and follow these standards:

- S500: Standard for Professional Water Damage Restoration
- S520: Standard for Professional Mold Remediation
- S540: Standard for Professional Fire and Smoke Damage Restoration

These standards are regularly updated. Always refer to the latest edition.

S500 - Water Damage Key Principles

Water Categories:

Category 1 (Clean Water): Originates from a sanitary source. Examples: broken supply line, rainwater.

Category 2 (Gray Water): Contains significant contamination. Examples: washing machine overflow, dishwasher discharge.

Category 3 (Black Water): Grossly unsanitary. Examples: sewage backup, rising flood water, toilet overflow with feces.

NOTE: Water category can escalate over time. Category 1 water can become Category 2 or 3 if left untreated.

Drying Classes:

Class 1: Least amount of moisture. Small area affected.

Class 2: Significant moisture. Entire room of carpet and cushion.

Class 3: Greatest amount of moisture. Water from overhead.

Class 4: Specialty drying. Deep pockets of saturation in hardwood, concrete, stone.

Documentation Requirements

IICRC standards require thorough documentation throughout every project:

- Initial moisture readings and thermal images
- Daily monitoring logs with psychometric data
- Equipment placement records
- Photos at every stage (before, during, after)
- Final moisture readings confirming drying goals met

Proper documentation protects both the company and the client, and is essential for insurance claims processing.